

ministries and agencies have accelerated emergency purchases without tendering or delaying their course of action. The largest government expenditure is presumed to be from defence, home and shipping ministries," informs Dua.

Surveillance equipment is on priority of the purchase list of airports, whose planned expenditure of about ₹ 197 billion (US\$ 3.2 billion) by 2016 is concentrated toward securing their parameters using detectors for passengers and baggage screening systems. He adds, "Installation of high-end IP based CCTV systems, access control, and personal and baggage screening systems have poured in an investment of about ₹ 10 billion (US\$ 164 million) by Indian railways. The shipping ministry has granted approx. ₹ 1.23 billion (US\$ 20 million) for securing ports and decks with CCTVs, vehicle-tracing systems and high-end technology, apart from just deploying two dedicated interceptor boats at each port. Indian police forces have also started deploying and installing metro-wide surveillance systems using CCTVs in numerous cities."

Government of India has also taken various other initiatives intended to uplift the overall industry, which in turn acts as a boon for the players operating in the market. "Allowance of foreign direct investment (FDI) and the permission for Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) deployment as private security forces happen to be some of the major initiatives taken so far," shares Roy.

Dua says, "Home ministry police modernisation programme, with a better regulation of traffic network using CCTVs, can be expected to bring momentum for the electronic security industry in India."

The future outlook

The commercial sector has shown significant development during the period 2008-2013, owing to the surging demand for office space, particularly in cities like Bengaluru, Delhi and

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Mumbai. The inflow of several MNCs in major cities across the country has led to a growth in demand for commercial space. The commercial space increased from 3.9 million square metres in 2008 to 4.8 million square metres in 2013. It is anticipated to reach 10.2 million square metres by 2018, increasing at a CAGR of 16.3 per cent over the period of 2013-2018. This will also lead to a growing demand for installation of electronic security equipment in coming years.

"As the cognizance of the benefits of IP based systems mushrooms, features and complexities of surveillance products will increase and costs will go down. IP surveillance in India has enhanced its reach into such verticals as government, small and medium-sized businesses (SMBs) and small offices/home offices (SOHOs)," says Dua. This market is expected to grow as organisations and authorities understand the advantages that IP based surveillance brings with it. He adds, "With IP equipment prices likely to fall faster than analogue CCTV equipment, the scales will increasingly tilt in favour of IP based systems."

Integrated security systems are anticipated to be the future of the electronic security market in India. An integrated security solution is designed by combining multiple security systems such as video surveillance, intrusion alarms, intruder alarms, fire alarms, intercoms and HVAC systems. "These security solutions are gaining popularity because of the increased investments being made by various companies across different industry verticals in order to upgrade their

Domestic production constitutes a microscopic share in the overall supply with respect to the Indian market. The scenario is expected to more or less remain the same during the forecast period due to low degree of support from the government and lack of technical expertise for mass production

security solutions to incorporate the latest technology devices," says Gupta.

From a technology viewpoint, Prabhu says, "We can see better compression standards and resolution in camera hardware in the future. The advent of thermal imaging for commercial and industrial deployment will see a flipip."

At the end of the day, the security of the country continues to be a key concern for the government and its various stakeholders, who are working to bring together the best security solutions and create a wide area security net, so that the nation's assets as well as its people remain safe and secure. The future is likely to see a reduction in import duties and taxes. Also, private equity investment is expected to increase significantly at least till 2020. ●

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